

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 6th September 2026

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 18:15–20

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that **reconciliation is a sacred responsibility**, rooted in love, humility and a desire for restored relationship.

When conflict or hurt arises, the first response should not be anger, gossip, avoidance or revenge, but a quiet and honest conversation with the person involved. This private dialogue gives space for **listening, understanding and healing**.

If the conflict cannot be resolved alone, Jesus encourages the involvement of trusted witnesses — not to shame or accuse, but to help guide the conversation with wisdom, fairness and care. When difficulties continue, the wider community has a role in encouraging accountability, unity and peace.

Remember LOVE

L — Listen with humility

Hear one another deeply and seek to understand.

O — Offer reconciliation

Choose restoration and forgiveness over pride.

V — Value community

Protect the unity, peace and wellbeing of the community.

E — Embrace divine presence

Trust that God is present wherever people gather in faith, prayer, forgiveness and harmony.

Jesus reminds us that **love is more than a feeling; it is a way of living**. Through patience, courage, humility and faith, conflict can become an opportunity for healing, forgiveness and renewed fellowship.

May the peace of Christ guide our hearts, strengthen our unity, and fill our community with love, forgiveness and grace. Amen.

Readings for Sunday 13th September

1st Reading: Sirach 27:30–28:7

Psalm: 102:1–4, 9–12

2nd Reading: Romans 14:7–9

Gospel: Matthew 18:21–35



Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise

Thursday: St Peter Claver

Saturday: St Ailbe; The Most Holy Name of Mary



Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

The **Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles** takes place on **Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm** in **St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.**

Following the blessing, all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, where a donation will be presented to the RNLI.

Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am** in **St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven**, for deceased bikers.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>



St Joseph's Men's Camino

A day of **pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal** takes place on **Saturday 12th September.**

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65 / €55 (including lunch and dinner)

Visit: www.dominicans.ie



Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day takes place **today (Sunday) at Termonbacca, Derry**, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

This will be followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie



Host for Hospice

October is Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month.

We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on — **it's a piece of cake!**

To request your **FREE host pack** or for more information, please contact:

Ailbhe, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice

☎ 028 71359888

✉ ailbhe@foylehospice.com



Job Opportunity

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **Sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour

Closing Date: 15/09/26

✉ recruitment@derrydiocese.org

☎ 028 71262302



Human Life International Ireland

Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, will visit Ireland as part of a Provincial Tour.

Join us for the **Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry**, on **29th September at 6.45 pm**, with a first-class relic of **St Thérèse**.

Season of Creation

During this **Season of Creation**, Pope Leo invites us to turn our attention to one of the most essential gifts for life: **water**.

Let us pray that we may learn to manage water with justice and responsibility, protecting it as a common good and ensuring that everyone has equitable access to it.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Course

The next Marriage Preparation Course takes place on **20th/21st November** at the **Ebrington Hotel, Derry**.

Booking online: www.accordni.com

Lough Derg Day Retreats

Day Retreats take place on:

September 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: www.loughderg.org

All welcome.

Rosary on the Coast

Rosary on the Coast takes place **today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm** at **Lisfannon Beach**, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies.

Everyone welcome.